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WE NEED A STRONG FOUNDATION OF SKILLED HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS FOR A SUSTAINABLE HEALTHCARE SYSTEM

have the capability to contribute to global universal health coverage goals through its telemedicine and digital health tools. Hence, increased advances in technology, and interest and activity from innovators, provides an opportunity for India to solve some of its long-existing challenges in providing appropriate healthcare to a large section of its population.

The integration of AI and machine learning can further assist in early diagnosis and personalised treatment plans. The power of digital and physical is coming together to build an efficient and impactful healthcare model. Primary care, diagnostics, secondary and tertiary care, and retail health, all linked and enabled through a dynamic integrated

digital platform are pivotal to this.

India's moonshot for health equity lies in embracing and leveraging medical technology, treatment and research. Looking ahead, the future of healthcare lies in automation, digitisation, robotics, 3D printing and in deep science, genomics and molecular biology.

Healing the World in India

The transformation of India into a hotspot for medical tourism can be traced back to the 1980s when private hospitals entered the scene, organising the healthcare market. Prior to this development, healthcare access was elusive for many. Today, India offers treatment to international patients at a mere fraction of the cost, approximately a tenth, providing access to the best

doctors equipped with relevant skills and leveraging the latest technological advancements, ensuring excellent clinical outcomes.

The Indian healthcare industry is on a par with the best in the world in terms of infrastructure, technology, specialist doctors and nurses. The country has the finest and one of the largest pools of doctors of global repute and paramedics in South Asia. India's expertise in highly specialised areas like organ transplant, cardiology, oncology, etc. has made the country a hotspot for medical value travel.

Further, to build a sustainable healthcare system, we need a strong foundation of skilled healthcare professionals. Investment in medical education and research is imperative. We must attract the brightest minds to the field of medicine, offering state-of-the-art facilities and fostering a culture of innovation. Research institutions and medical colleges should collaborate seamlessly to drive advancements in medical science and contribute to the global pool of knowledge.

In conclusion, the next five years present an unparalleled opportunity for India to redefine its healthcare landscape. By prioritising universal healthcare access, preventive measures, technological innovation, medical education, and fostering collaboration between the public and private sectors, we can pave the way for a healthier and more prosperous nation. As we embark on this journey, let us remember that a healthy India is not just a goal; it is the cornerstone of our collective well-being and prosperity.

To a flourishing nation, today and always. Here is wishing everyone good health, happiness and boundless prosperity in the New Year. **BT**

The author is Chairman & Founder of Apollo Hospitals. Views are personal